

Allegiance to Gratitude

Reading annotations | Pages 83-91

These are suggested margin notes based on all the reading photos. Copy the notes that match your reactions beside the relevant passages. Mark questions with ? and reactions with !. Circle vocabulary only if it is unfamiliar to you.

Page 83 | Morning rituals

! Kimmerer's morning gratitude ritual introduces the idea that appreciation can be part of everyday life.

? Why does her daughter refuse to stand for a ritual that most students follow?

Page 84 | Liberty and personal beliefs

! Her daughter points out a contradiction: forcing someone to say words about liberty takes away that person's freedom to choose.

? Can repeating a promise bring people together if some people do not believe it is true?

Page 85 | The Onondaga Nation School

! The students begin and end the school week with gratitude. Saying the Address in their own language also helps keep their culture alive.

Pages 86-87 | Illustrated Thanksgiving Address

! The illustration places people, plants, animals, water, and the sky together. It helps show that humans belong to a larger community of life.

? Why are the Earth, Sun, and Moon described using family relationships?

Page 88 | Community and sovereignty

! "Now our minds are one" makes gratitude a shared action. The school's own tradition also expresses its cultural identity and self-rule.

Page 89 | Gratitude and science

! The Address is also a science lesson because it names parts of the ecosystem and explains how they support life.

? How might thanking water change the way people use and protect it?

Page 90 | Recognizing everyday gifts

! Berries and other foods are gifts the children can actually see and enjoy. That helps explain why gratitude may feel more meaningful than an abstract political promise.

Page 91 | The listener's responsibility

! The listener gives something back through attention and a spoken response. Unity takes effort from everyone, not just the speaker.

? Would this ceremony have the same effect if people repeated the words without paying attention?

Reading annotations

Pages 92-99 and vocabulary

Pages 92-93 | Gratitude and contentment

! Recognizing what we already have challenges the idea that we always need to buy more. Gratitude can change both our attitude and our behavior.

Pages 93-94 | Leadership

! The eagle and maple teach that leaders should watch over others and give generously. Leadership is a responsibility to serve, not just a chance to have power.

Pages 94-95 | Interdependence and common ground

? If people depend on the same land, air, and water, should their responsibilities reach beyond national borders?

! Starting with shared needs could help people cooperate before debating their differences.

? How does a community reach consensus when its members strongly disagree?

Page 96 | Environmental responsibility

! Listing nature's gifts also helps people notice what has been damaged or lost. Gratitude should lead to repairing that damage.

Page 97 | Reciprocity

! Receiving clean water or food creates a responsibility to care for the sources of those gifts. Saying thanks is only the beginning.

? What would giving something back to a stream look like in everyday life?

Page 98 | Sharing respectfully

! Kimmerer asks permission before sharing a tradition from a nation she does not belong to. Oren Lyons explains that the Address is meant to be shared.

Page 99 | The ending

! The ending reverses the usual relationship: the author hopes the land will someday have reason to thank people. This makes reciprocity the final challenge of the essay.

? What could we change so that the land benefits from our presence?

Words to circle if unfamiliar

Sovereignty (p. 88): independence or self-rule. Invocation (p. 89): calling upon a higher power or authority. Cynicism (p. 94): distrust of people's motives. Hypocrisy (p. 94): claiming beliefs that your actions contradict. Interdependence (p. 94): relying on one another. Credo (p. 97): a statement of guiding beliefs.

Context clues: consensus (p. 95) means shared agreement; reciprocity (p. 97) means giving back in response to what you receive.

Sources: the supplied reading photos, IMG_7298-IMG_7306, and annotation directions in IMG_7307. Page references follow the photographed edition.